

Radical Choices



Leadership in Recovery Using Disruptive Learning Technology™ Participant Workbook Day Two

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1. DLT Feedback: Key to Success



Being able to give and receive feedback is extremely important in this training. How else can we see our blind spots unless people we trust help us?

2. The Reactive Self

A reaction is when you respond to the present situation from the past.

When we are “in reaction,” our responses are coming from automatic pilot, from our past, from all the ways we learned to act in childhood when our feelings and thoughts were not okay with the people around us.

So, what is so important about our Reactive Self? We have an old response to something—so what? We think we are feeling one thing and are really feeling something else—what difference does it make? We blame somebody or something for what we are feeling—is this so unusual?

No, most of us blame someone or something for what we are feeling. Many of us are not aware of what we are feeling, and most of us respond to what happens in the present the way we did ten, twenty or thirty years ago. There’s nothing “wrong” or “bad” with any of it. Yet, this behavior keeps us at a disadvantage.. We end up perpetuating old patterns that prevent us from achieving our present day goals.

Dissolving our Reactive Selves always involves telling ourselves something we don’t want to hear.

2.1. The Reactive Self – How to Recognize It

There are several ways, then, you can tell when you are in reaction:

- When your body language is rigid (you cover your eyes, or face, or fold your arms)
- When your comments are irrelevant to what is being discussed
- When your affect is numb, foggy, confused or angry
- When you make judgments rather than thought out feedback and evaluation.
- Whenever you are compelled to act or not act
- When you act as if you are in a courtroom, presenting good evidence and prove beyond a shadow of a doubt that you are right about your point of view.
- When you want to argue, find fault, want to make everything okay.

3. Personal Responsibility

To some, the word “responsibility” may connote “doing the right thing” or bearing the “burden” of responsibility.

In the context of DLT, to be personally responsible is defined as “response-ability.” Being Personally Responsible means, literally, being able to respond. It means people choose the behavior that will get their desired results, rather than the behavior dictated by their feelings. This also means acknowledging oneself as the source of their feelings and results. Thus, the leader can consciously choose how to respond to any situation instead of being stuck with patterned responses from the past.

Now, how can you be personally responsible?

- Assuming positive intent on the part of others. Even if you can prove the opposite.
- Being in the present rather than in the past
- Acting in a way that promotes getting the results we desire
- Choosing not to defend, blame, justify, or judge

3.1. Application Activity: Personal Responsibility Scene Study - One More Feeling

Scene One: The Client is Always Right

The Characters: A recovery facility counselor and two clients in a CBT group.

The Situation: The group has broken up into pairs to discuss what event precipitated them coming to the facility. The instructions are to share their story of addiction and what has worked and not worked for them in recovery.

Scene Two: Let Go and Let God

Characters: A recovery facility counselor and two clients.

Situation: A facility counselor is conducting a sober living exit training to two clients about to leave the rehab facility

Scene Three: The Legend of Filial Piety

The Characters: A recovery facility counselor, a teenage client and her mother

The Situation: The counselor has just offered a fairly complicated piece of theory on the roots of addiction and neither the client or her mother are responding in any recognizable way.

4. Reactions as Pitfalls: Judgment, Interpretation, Projection

4.1. *Judgment*

When you make a judgment, it is always about you, not the other person. Our judgments stem from something inside ourselves. How many of us judge ourselves?

Judgments always attribute negative or positive motivation. When we judge we give up our power to deal with life situations. Judging substitutes for action, because once we judge, we distance our self from the situation.

Then our possibility for awakened action in that moment is gone.

4.2. *Interpretation*

When we interpret, we are only in relationship with our own mind, not with the other person. When that occurs, we continue to condition our next response.

We interpret other people's behavior. How many have ever assumed you knew why someone said or did something? How many have discovered later that your assumption was wrong?

When we interpret, our experience is the way we believe things are, instead of what is true.

4.3. *Projection*

When we are having an experience we don't like, we act as if the other person is causing the experience. This is called projection.

When we assume a motive behind something, we're projecting. This can be positive or negative. If we do this with customers, it causes a disconnect and we can't get to the real problem.

Projection is a destructive form of behavior because it's based on denial. It's taking what we won't tolerate about ourselves, and putting it out on to the other person. Or taking what we admire in another and seeing them as special or better than.

Any time we have an experience that doesn't fit our picture of who we are, we attribute our emotion to another person. If it is a negative feeling we do it to distance ourselves. If it is a positive emotion, we lose ourselves as well. Whether positive or negative, we are unable to experience our natural emotions.

6. Authenticity

Authenticity is sharing your natural self. Everyone can tell if someone is being real. They may not consciously know why, but everyone feels it if someone is pretending. Authenticity attracts others who are also authentic. It's hard-wired into our brains as a survival mechanism.

We have been told repeatedly by society and shown by our family upbringing that we are supposed to hide certain emotions and not show our full humanness. We have been taught that it is better to repress, subliminate and ignore feelings that are "negative." The definition of which are "negative" vary according to your family's beliefs and history.

When we hide or repress our emotions, we eventually end up hiding them from ourselves. When that occurs, people around us pick up that which is not said and respond to our conflict with a conflict of their own...We are incongruent when we show one face on the outside and another to ourselves. When this occurs, our work and family suffer. We usually become ill or medicate ourselves. Our relationships and our results suffer.

6.1. You Always Communicate Your Intention

When a person's heart and mind are integrated, his communication is very clear. You don't ever have to think about what he's saying. You don't ever have to figure out the message when this integration is present. You don't ever have to hear different voices when he's talking. You just hear what he's saying and the message goes right into your body.

There is no incongruity between what they're saying and what they're feeling; what their minds are saying and what their hearts are saying. When this occurs in a leader success is the only thing possible.

7. Integrity

Our definition of integrity comes from a professor at MIT, Michael Jenson. It doesn't have an ethical or moral connotation or religious or philosophical basis. It is simple and elegant: You honor your word. We know we cannot always keep our word. We can always honor our word.

There are times when reality changes and we are unable to keep our word. We let the person know as ahead of time as we can. We ask them what they need so that they are whole. The times we don't honor our word add fire to our un-experienced anxiety.

Clues for knowing Integrity	Clues for Lack of Integrity
Vulnerable	Denial
Clarity	Illusion
Transparency (one face)	Noncommittal
Receive support	Projection and blame
Listening	Reaction
Proactive	Control
Responsible	Default
Spontaneity	Dread
Choice	Stuck

7.1. Lack of Integrity Application Exercise: Cleaning Up The Mess

Are you out of integrity at work by withholding part of yourself?

Are you out of integrity at work by pretending to be someone other than you are?

Are you out of integrity at work by changing your speech "to keep the peace"?

Are you out of integrity at work by hiding how you feel?

Are you out of integrity at work to get your way?

What lies are you telling yourself?

What is the effect of being out of integrity at work?

8. Six Principles of DLT

8.1. Insight

Knowing yourself and knowing others. Insight lets us know where our beliefs, values and points of view come from and how we view them. We see where in our lives we were conditioned to think, believe and feel the way we do. Insight is the preparation for Personal Responsibility.

8.2. Personal Responsibility

Owning yourself. Knowing that we are the source and authority of our experience, and recognizing how we create our results – tangible and intangible. Making amends for blame and judgment by dissolving 'right vs. wrong', 'better vs. worse' thinking in favor of a more balanced view and assuming that others have a positive intent. Handling damaged relationships.

8.3. Authenticity

Difference between reactive sharing and sharing your natural self. Everyone can tell if someone is being real. They may not consciously know why, but everyone feels it if someone is pretending. Authenticity attracts others who are also authentic. It's hard-wired into our brains as a survival mechanism. Taking risks. Taking a stand. Being true.

8.4. Integrity

What do you stand for and how you honor your word. You are your word. You walk your talk. You don't make promises you do not intend to keep. You tell the truth. Of course, your truth is not absolute and can change as you evolve.

8.5. Clear Mind

The fullness of clarity. The state of being that is without bias or preconceptions. Having openness to what is occurring in the present moment. Brings the ability to live in Paradox. Living in Paradox allows the brain to become an open system developing new neural pathways and alternative problem solving skills.

8.6. Awakened Action

Knowing what action to take to benefit yourself and others – being connected. Brings an ability to build collaboration and unity. Understands differing perspectives and how they are part of a whole. No need to argue about who is right anymore.

***Thank you for participating in day 2 of our Leadership in
Recovery Workshop. We enjoyed being with you.***

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